全民英檢中級 GEPT Intermediate | 第 4 單元 | 居家與住宅 · Home & Housing

Your First Apartment: A Survival Guide

第一間租屋生存指南

Moving out of your parents' home is exciting, but finding affordable accommodation in Taipei can be a headache. Housing near MRT stations is expensive, and many students end up renting a room on the fifth storey of a building with no elevator. Before you sign anything, here are a few tips that every first-time tenant should know.

First, visit the property in person, and never rely only on photos. Check whether the room is already furnished; a bed, a desk, and a small fridge can save you thousands of dollars. Turn on every appliance, including the air-conditioner and the water heater, and look under the basin for signs of a leak. Flip the light switches to make sure no bulb is dead, and run the tap to see how fast the water goes down the drain. If the hallway is covered in dust and the staircase smells of garbage, the landlord probably does not take good care of the building.

Second, understand what you are paying for. Ask whether household bills such as water, electricity, and internet are included in the rent. Some landlords charge a flat fee; others calculate electricity by the meter, which can be costly in summer. Find out how long the room has been vacant. If it has been empty for months, you may be able to bargain for a lower price.

Finally, keep a good relationship with your landlady or landlord. Pay the rent on time, keep the corridor clear, and report problems early. A dripping tap that is ignored for weeks can turn into a flooded floor. Remember: a good tenant usually gets the deposit back, while a careless one leaves with nothing but a bag of dirty laundry and regret.

重點單字 Key Vocabulary

單字	詞性	中文	例句
accommodation	*n.*	住處；住宿	The hotel offers cheap accommodation for students. 這家旅館提供學生便宜的住宿。
housing	*n.*	住宅；住房	The city is building more housing for young families. 市政府正為年輕家庭興建更多住宅。

storey	*n.*	樓層	Our office is on the top storey of the building. 我們的辦公室在大樓的頂樓。
tenant	*n.*	房客	The tenant pays the rent on the first day of each month. 房客每個月一號付房租。
property	*n.*	房地產；財產	The old property by the river was sold last week. 河邊那棟老房子上週賣掉了。
furnish	*v.*	為…配備家具	The apartment is furnished with a sofa and two beds. 這間公寓附有一張沙發和兩張床。
appliance	*n.*	家電	A rice cooker is the most important appliance in our kitchen. 電鍋是我們廚房裡最重要的家電。
leak	*n.*	漏水；漏洞	There is a leak in the roof, so the floor is wet. 屋頂漏水，所以地板是濕的。
landlord	*n.*	房東	Our landlord fixed the broken window the next day. 我們的房東隔天就修好了破掉的窗戶。
vacant	*adj.*	空著的	The shop on the corner has been vacant for a year. 轉角那間店面已經空了一年。

片語 Phrases

end up + V-ing	最後落得…；結果變成…	We missed the last bus and ended up walking home. 我們錯過末班公車，最後只好走路回家。
in person	親自	You must sign the form in person. 你必須親自簽這份表格。
take care of	照顧；維護	Who will take care of the garden while you are away? 你不在的時候誰來照顧花園？

文法與句型 Grammar

S + V + whether + S + V

whether 引導名詞子句，意思是「是否…」，常接在 check、ask、know、wonder 等動詞後面。

Check whether the room is already furnished.

確認房間是否已經附家具。

S + V, while + S + V

while 在此表示「而；然而」，用來對比兩個相反的情況，不是「當…時」的意思。

A good tenant gets the deposit back, while a careless one gets nothing.

好房客拿得回押金，而粗心的房客什麼都拿不到。

讀完文章後，請到「皇家大衛英文閱讀集點站」完成本單元測驗，答對即可累積點數。